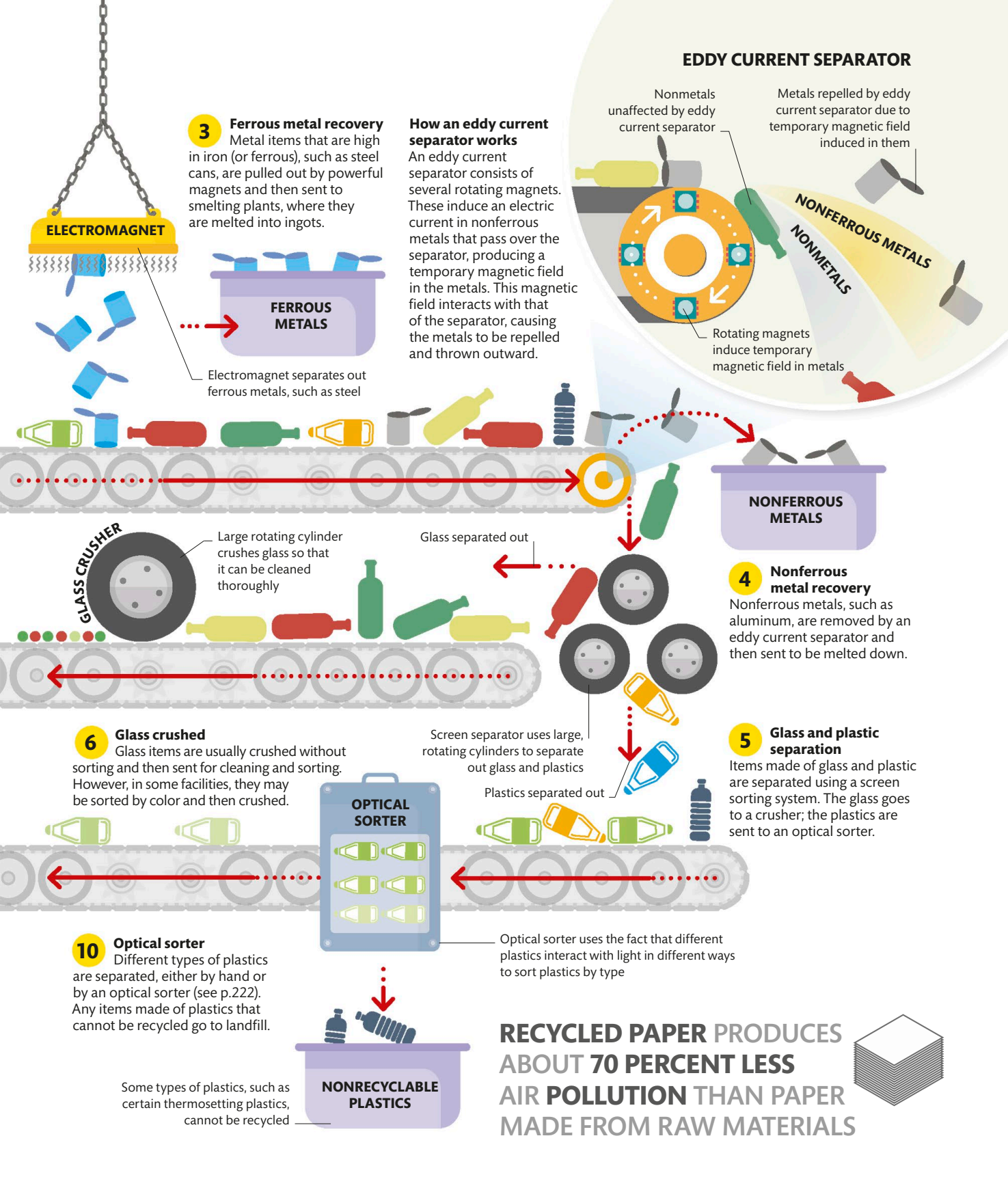


3 Ferrous metal recovery
Metal items that are high in iron (or ferrous), such as steel cans, are pulled out by powerful magnets and then sent to smelting plants, where they are melted into ingots.

How an eddy current separator works
An eddy current separator consists of several rotating magnets. These induce an electric current in nonferrous metals that pass over the separator, producing a temporary magnetic field in the metals. This magnetic field interacts with that of the separator, causing the metals to be repelled and thrown outward.

4 Nonferrous metal recovery
Nonferrous metals, such as aluminum, are removed by an eddy current separator and then sent to be melted down.

5 Glass and plastic separation
Items made of glass and plastic are separated using a screen sorting system. The glass goes to a crusher; the plastics are sent to an optical sorter.

6 Glass crushed
Glass items are usually crushed without sorting and then sent for cleaning and sorting. However, in some facilities, they may be sorted by color and then crushed.

10 Optical sorter
Different types of plastics are separated, either by hand or by an optical sorter (see p.222). Any items made of plastics that cannot be recycled go to landfill.

RECYCLED PAPER PRODUCES ABOUT **70 PERCENT LESS** AIR **POLLUTION** THAN PAPER MADE FROM RAW MATERIALS